Lesson plan · for the teacher

Keep pupils' data private

AI · Level 2 · Lesson 4

Time
40 min

Materials
A set of about ten information cards per group (the lesson plan lists them), or the ten items numbered on the board; Three circles drawn on the board: green, amber and red (or three sheets of paper); Chalk or tape to put the cards up

Learning goals

- Sort information into fine to share, only without names, and never.
- Make information safer by removing names and clues.
- Explain why what goes into an AI tool can come out again.

Activity: Traffic light

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask: would you shout this across the market? "Today's homework is page 12." "My friend's exam mark." "My home address." Pupils show thumbs up or down for each and say why.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain simply: when we type into an AI tool, our words go to a company's computers and are kept. They may be used to teach later versions, which can repeat what they learned. So some things never go in. Mention that many AI tools are only for people aged 13 and over.
3. Traffic light (15 min): Give each group a set of cards. Groups sort them into three piles: green (fine to share with an AI tool), amber (only without names) and red (never). Then they stick them up under the circles on the board.
4. Make it safer (7 min): Each group picks one red card and rewrites it so that it could be amber or green; for example, "Ade scored 4 out of 10" becomes "A pupil scored 4 out of 10". Some cards, such as a home address, stay red.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Discuss the cards that groups placed differently, and agree on the safest choice. Then give the exit ticket.

Make one set of ten cards per group: a lesson topic, a question about fractions, the school timetable, a story with made-up names, a poem a pupil wrote, a test score with a name, a class photo, a pupil's home address, a note about an illness, a parent's phone number. Draw green, amber and red circles on the board. No time to make sets? Write the ten items on the board, numbered; each group writes green, amber or red next to each number on a scrap of paper.

Discussion

- Which card was hardest to sort, and why?
- How can we turn a red card into an amber one?
- Why can something we type into an AI tool come out again?

Exit ticket

- Write one piece of information that must never go into an AI tool, and why.

Try it at school tomorrow
Play "Traffic light": Groups sort cards of information into green (fine to share with an AI tool), amber (only without names) and red (never). Then talk about the cards they found hard.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **Why could a pupil's details, typed into a chatbot, turn up again later?**

- ◯ Other users can open your chats
- ◯ Chats can train models that repeat things
- ◯ Chatbots post every chat online

2 **Which of these must never go into a public AI tool? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ A list of pupils' names with their test marks
- ☐ "Write five questions about the water cycle for Primary 4"
- ☐ A photo of the class on sports day
- ☐ A note with a pupil's name and her epilepsy
- ☐ "Pupil A: strong reader, finds fractions hard"

3 **If you delete a chat straight after using it, the pupil data you typed is gone for good.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **Complete the checklist.**

Before you use an AI tool, check its _____ (are chats used for training?), its _____ rules and the rules of your _____ .

Word bank: battery · school · settings · price · age

✎ **Which task in your week could AI help with if you took the personal details out? What would you remove first?**

Check your answers

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1 **Chats can train models that repeat things**

Chats can become training data, and models sometimes repeat what they learned, word for word.

2 **A list of pupils' names with their test marks; A note with a pupil's name and her epilepsy; A photo of the class on sports day**

Names with marks, a named child's health, and photos point to real children.

3 **False**

Deleting removes it from your list, but the company may keep copies for a while, and it may already have been processed.

4 **Before you use an AI tool, check its settings (are chats used for training?), its age rules and the rules of your school.**

Settings (is training on your chats switched off?), age rules (often 13, with a parent's permission under 18) and your school's rules decide whether, and how, a tool can be used.